

The 2025 LLM Usage Landscape

Real-World Data from OpenRouter

Based on real usage data from millions of OpenRouter users
Covering the most recent week of March 2025

~26T

tokens processed this week

↑ 13× growth year-over-year (from ~2T to ~26T)

Audience: LLM R&D • Product • Investment

This Week's Top 10 Models

OpenRouter Rankings · Latest week of March 2025

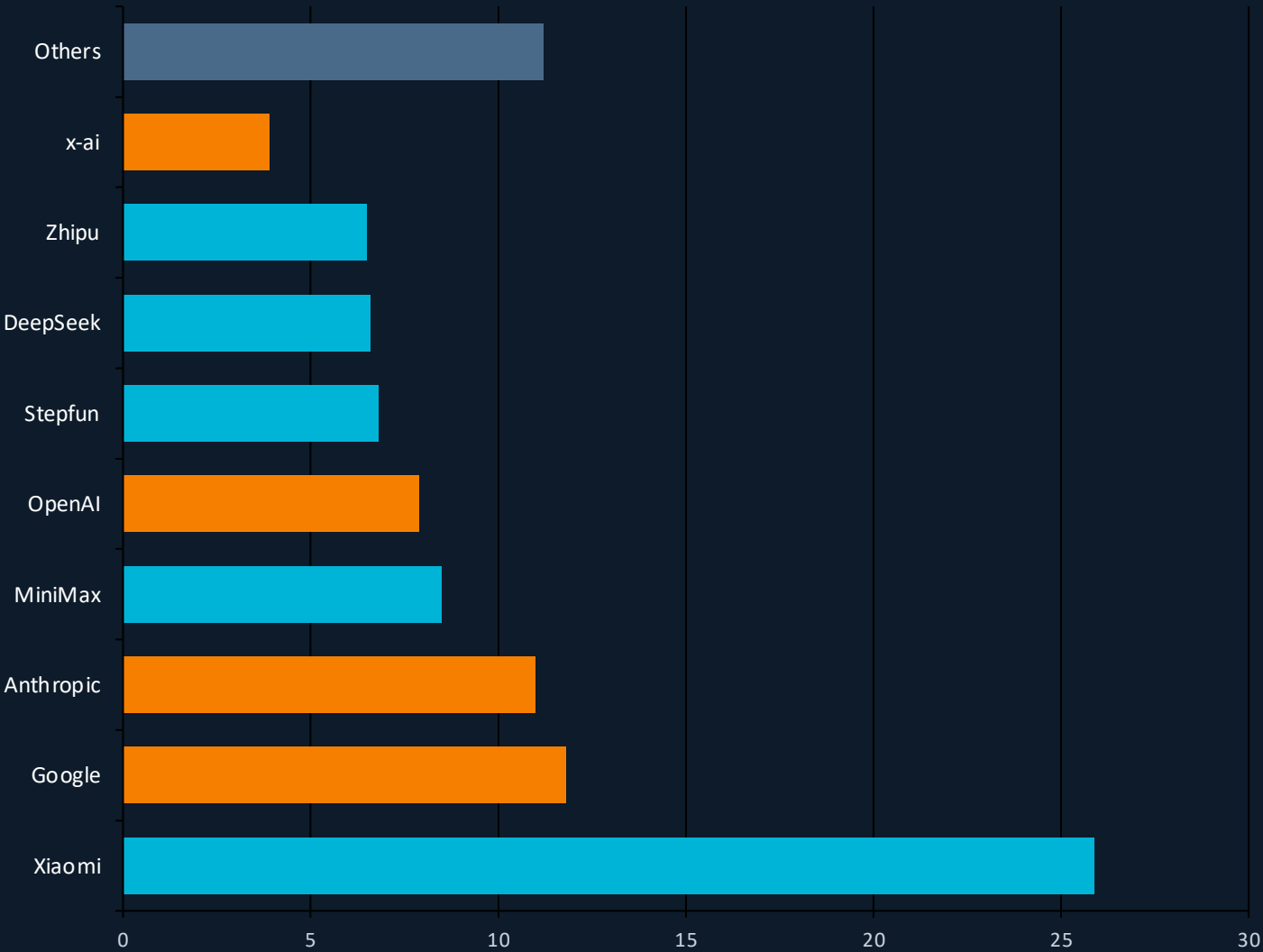
#	Model	Provider	Weekly Tokens	WoW Δ
1	MiMo-V2-Pro	Xiaomi	3.96T	+165%
2	Step 3.5 Flash (free)	Stepfun	1.49T	+1%
3	MiniMax M2.7	MiniMax	1.29T	+253%
4	DeepSeek V3.2	DeepSeek	1.24T	+9%
5	Claude Sonnet 4.6	Anthropic	1.04T	-0%
6	Claude Opus 4.6	Anthropic	995B	+2%
7	Gemini 3 Flash Preview	Google	972B	+3%
8	GLM 5 Turbo	Zhipu (z-ai)	968B	-6%
9	MiniMax M2.5	MiniMax	909B	-30%
10	Grok 4.1 Fast	x-ai	599B	+32%

Key Highlights

- 🇨🇳 Chinese providers hold 6 of 10 spots
- MiMo-V2-Pro leads at 3.96T tokens (+165% WoW)
- MiniMax M2.7 fastest growing: +253% WoW
- Anthropic holds #5 & #6 — but growth stalled
- Flash/Turbo variants dominate usage

Provider Market Share Breakdown

By weekly token volume · March 2025



25.9%

Xiaomi — #1 provider, more than 2× #2 Google

54.3% combined share

Chinese providers: Xiaomi + MiniMax + Stepfun + DeepSeek + Zhipu

- OpenAI ranks only 5th at 7.9%
- No single provider exceeds 30%
- Market remains highly fragmented

Shifts in the Market Landscape

Key competitive dynamics shaping the LLM market in 2025

Chinese Models Break Through Globally

>54%

combined market share

On OpenRouter — an international platform — Chinese providers (Xiaomi, MiniMax, Stepfun, DeepSeek, Zhipu) collectively hold over half of all token consumption.

Xiaomi's MiMo series, DeepSeek V3, and MiniMax M2 lead with a strong cost-performance edge.

Flash / Turbo Variants Outpace Flagships

4 of 10

top models are fast/cheap variants

Step 3.5 Flash, GLM 5 Turbo, Gemini 3 Flash, and Grok 4.1 Fast see far higher usage than premium counterparts.

In real-world deployment, speed and cost-efficiency consistently outrank peak benchmark performance.

Explosive Market Growth — 13× in 12 Months

~2T → ~26T

weekly tokens (Mar 2025 vs Mar 2024)

The OpenRouter weekly token chart shows the market has grown from ~2T to ~26T tokens per week over the past year.

Rapid ecosystem expansion driven by agentic use cases, coding assistants, and the proliferation of affordable models.

This Week's Rising Stars: Fastest-Growing Models

Week-over-week token growth · March 2025

Ampere

+576%

Ampere

Extraordinary debut — near-zero base → massive spike

MiniMax M2.7

+253%

MiniMax

New generation release drives replacement of M2.5

MiMo-V2-Pro

+165%

Xiaomi

#1 overall model — explosive adoption across dev tooling

Codex

+112%

OpenAI

Coding-focused revival; rides AI coding assistant boom

Cline

+128%

Independent

Top coding agent; autonomous task execution resonates

Hermes Agent

+92%

Nous Research

Agentic workflows gain traction in enterprise/research

App Ecosystem: Who's Calling These Models

Top apps by daily token consumption · March 2025

#	App	Description	Tokens/Day	Coding?
1	OpenClaw	AI productivity assistant	829B	⚙️ Yes
2	Kilo Code	VS Code AI coding assistant	271B	⚙️ Yes
3	Claude Code	Anthropic CLI coding tool	78B	⚙️ Yes
4	Cline	VS Code autonomous coding agent	69.1B	⚙️ Yes
5	Janitor AI	Character roleplay chat	29.2B	—
6	ISEKAI ZERO	AI adventure game	28.8B	—
7	Descript	AI video / podcast editor	27B	—
8	Hermes Agent	Nous Research AI agent	19.2B	—
9	Roo Code	VS Code AI coding assistant	11.8B	—
10	Scripty	Newly launched tool	9.95B	—

Key Insight

4 of top 4 apps
are AI coding tools

OpenClaw · Kilo Code · Claude Code · Cline

OpenClaw dominates at 829B tokens/day
— nearly 3× second place (Kilo Code at 271B)

Entertainment apps (Janitor AI, ISEKAI ZERO)
still hold notable presence in top 10

AI coding agents have become the single
largest LLM consumption scenario

Key Insights and Industry Implications

What the data tells us about the LLM market in 2025

01 Chinese Models Now Dominate Global Usage

On OpenRouter — an international platform — Chinese providers hold >54% combined market share. Xiaomi alone commands 25.9%, more than double #2 Google. Cost-performance advantages are translating directly into global deployment.

→ **Implication:** Western model providers face real competitive pressure outside benchmark leaderboards.

02 AI Coding Agents Are the #1 LLM Use Case

4 of the top 4 apps by daily token volume are coding tools. OpenClaw consumes 829B tokens/day alone — 3× the #2 app. Coding assistants represent the largest commercial value proposition for LLMs today.

→ **Implication:** Optimize for coding benchmarks, low latency, and IDE integration.

03 Market Is Highly Fragmented — No Clear Winner

Top 10 models span 8 different providers. No single model exceeds ~25% of total usage. The market remains fiercely competitive with rapid weekly shifts.

→ **Implication:** Moat is not yet established — new entrants can still gain meaningful share quickly.

04 Speed + Affordability Beat Peak Performance in Practice

Flash/Turbo variants (Step 3.5 Flash, GLM 5 Turbo, Gemini 3 Flash, Grok 4.1 Fast) consistently outpace flagship models in real-world usage. Users vote with their wallets and latency requirements.

→ **Implication:** Inference efficiency is a primary product axis, not just an afterthought.